

سورة ق

Sūrat Qāf • The Letter Qāf

Full-density gloss translation, every content word carried to its root and its concrete floor • blocks graded found or authored

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Bismillāh ar-Raḥmān ar-Raḥīm

Sūrat Qāf is the fiftieth sūra of the Qurʾān, forty-five verses, Meccan, and it takes its name from the single disconnected letter standing at its head. It opens the Ḥizb al-Mufaṣṣal, the last of the seven manzils, and the record holds that the Prophet ﷺ recited it at the two ʿids and from the pulpit often enough that one of the women of the Anṣār reported learning it from his mouth. That report is transmitted material and enters here as witness only.

The sūra is built on one axis and states it in its own rhyme. The word *baʿīd*, far, falls three times and only three times: the deniers open with it, saying the return is a far return; the yoked companion closes with it at the judgment, saying the man was in far error; and between the two the text negates the word outright, bringing the Garden near, *ghayra baʿīd*, not far. Against that stand *aqrab*, nearer than the vein of the neck, and the caller who calls from a near place. Distance is what the covered eye reports and nearness is what the text states.

The arc runs in one motion. An oath, an objection, and then the answer to the objection given not as argument but as a thing standing in front of the objector: a sky built without a seam, ground spread and moored, water sent down, dead land revived, and the emergence named as the same motion under a particle of sameness. Then the roll of those who denied before, then the interior, the whispering self and the nearness closer than the neck's own vessel, the two seated receivers and the ready watcher. Then the crossing: the stopping-up of death, the horn, the driver and the witness, and the cover lifted so the sight goes iron. Then the two ends, the cavity that asks whether there is more and the Garden brought forward to close range with the more held at the source. The sūra closes on patience, on the swimming praise before sunrise and before setting, on the caller from the near place, and on the one instruction the messenger is given about force: he is not set over them as one who compels.

This gloss runs at full density. Every content word carries its transliteration, its root, and its concrete floor, in that order, on first occurrence in the unit; particles run plain, and a word already glossed runs plain thereafter. The floor is excavated under the Concreteness Hierarchy, the body first, then the field and sky, then motion, and the abstract sense opened only after the physical one. Where a root genuinely carries two senses that are not synonyms, both print. Where a reading is contested, the contest prints with it. Honorifics stand outside the apparatus and are never glossed.

The blocks below carry their grade on the header. **Head at verse N** marks a division the text supplies, where the block's first verse states an operation and the verses under it supply its instances, checked against three marks. **Reader's cut** marks a division supplied here, for pace or because the passage's genre bars a head at intake. The distinction is printed because a reader who cannot tell an authored cut from a found one is reading the scribe's structure as the text's.

The Oath and the Objection · verse: 1-5 · reader's cut

The found grade is barred at intake here on the formula opening, and the corpus supplies its own control: Q 38:1-2 runs the identical shape, a disconnected letter, an oath by the Qur'ān carrying an epithet, then bal. A recurring opening shape is a convention of the opening and not a head, and bal turns away from verse one rather than expanding it, so the oath is not the title of what follows. The division below is the reader's, cut for pace.

Qāf. (*qāf*; the disconnected letter, unglossed: it names itself and carries no root) **By the Recitation** (*al-Qur'ān*; √Q-R-; the gathering, and the reading aloud of what is gathered) **that fills out its measure** (*al-majīd*; √M-J-D; abundance filling a space full; recd. glorious) **(1) Rather, they found it strange** (*ʿajībū*; √ʿ-J-B; the halt of a mind at what it cannot place) **that a warner** (*mundhir*; √N-DH-R; giving notice of a thing feared, cognate with *nadhr*, the vow) **had come** (*jā'a*; √J-Y-; arriving, coming to) **to them from among themselves, and the coverers-over** (*al-kāfirūn*; √K-F-R; covering a thing until it is hidden, as the sower buries seed, 57:20) **said, this is a strange thing** (*shay'*; √SH-Y-; a thing, from the same root as willing, cf. 50:35) **(2) When we are dead** (*mitnā*; √M-W-T; the going-still of what moved) **and have become dust** (*turāb*; √T-R-B; the loose earth of the ground) **? That is a far return** (*raj'*; √R-J-; going back the way one came · *ba'id*; √B-ʿ-D; distance between two places) **(3) We have known** (*ʿalimnā*; √ʿ-L-M; *alam*, the raised landmark that tells one place from another) **what the ground** (*al-ard*; √ʿ-R-D; the low broad surface underfoot) **chips away** (*tanquṣu*; √N-Q-Ṣ; taking a piece off an edge until the whole is less) **of them, and with Us is a record** (*kitāb*; √K-T-B; to stitch, to join one piece to another) **that keeps** (*ḥafīz*; √Ḥ-F-Z; holding a thing so nothing is lost from it) **(4) Rather, they called the settled truth a lie** (*kadhhabū*; √K-DH-B; II, to name a thing false · *al-ḥaqq*; √Ḥ-Q-Q; a thing fixed in its place, and the falling-due of what is owed) **when it came to them, so they are in a tangled matter** (*amr*; √-M-R; the thing commanded, the affair · *marīj*; √M-R-J; two things let loose together and mingling, cf. *marīj min nār*, 55:15, and *maraja al-baḥrayn*, 55:19) **(5)**

The Built Sky and the Revived Ground · verse: 6-11 · head at verse 6

Verse six states the operation, the looking and the seamless vault, and verses seven through eleven supply its particulars one after another: ground spread and moored, water sent down, garden, palm, revived tract. No new operation opens inside the block, and the head's samā' returns at verse nine where the water is sent down from it.

Have they not looked (*yanẓurū*; √N-Z-R; the eye turned deliberately toward a thing) **at the sky** (*al-samā'*; √S-M-W; what is raised high, and the height itself) **above them, how We built it** (*banaynā*; √B-N-Y; laying one course upon another) **and adorned it** (*zayyannā*; √Z-Y-N; setting on a thing what makes the eye rest on it) **and it has no gaps** (*furūj*; √F-R-J; the cleft between two things, the interstice that lets through) **(6) And the ground, We stretched it out** (*madadnā*; √M-D-D; drawing a thing to its length) **and cast into it** (*alqaynā*; √L-Q-Y; throwing down, and meeting) **firm moorings** (*rawāsī*; √R-S-W; a ship's anchor holding, the same root as *mursābā*, where the Hour is moored, 7:187, and *majrābā wa mursābā*, 11:41) **and made grow in it** (*anbatnā*; √N-B-T; the shoot breaking the surface) **every gladdening pair** (*zawj*; √Z-W-J; one of two that go together, each needing the other to be counted · *babij*; √B-H-J; brightness that lifts the one who sees it) **(7) A giving of sight** (*tabṣirah*; √B-Ṣ-R; the eye's own seeing, the organ before the insight) **and a reminding** (*dhikrā*; √DH-K-R; bringing back to the tongue what was held) **for every servant** (*abd*; √ʿ-B-D; *ṭarīq mu'abbad*, a road worn smooth by being walked; the servant is the trodden way) **who turns back again and again** (*munīb*; √N-W-B; returning by turns, coming round a second time and a third) **(8) And We sent down** (*nazzalnā*; √N-Z-L; II, coming down by stages and not at once) **from the sky water** (*mā'*; √M-W-H; water) **that settles and stays** (*mubārak*; √B-R-K; *baraka*, the camel folding its legs to the ground and remaining there; recd. blessed) **and We made grow with it gardens** (*jannāt*; √J-N-N; covering over until hidden, the root of *janīn*, the one hidden in the womb, and of *jinn*, the unseen) **and the grain of the harvest** (*ḥabb*; √Ḥ-B-B; the seed, and the loving · *ḥasīd*; √Ḥ-Ṣ-D; cutting the standing crop at its base) **(9) And the date-palm** (*al-nakhl*; √N-KH-L; the palm, and the sifting of fine from coarse) **towering** (*bāsiqāt*; √B-S-Q; rising far above what stands beside it) **with spathes** (*ṭal'*; √Ṭ-L-; the coming-up and out, the same root as the sun's rising, 50:39) **stacked in ranks** (*naḍīd*; √N-Ḍ-D; laid one on another in even courses) **(10) Provision** (*rizq*; √R-Z-Q; the portion apportioned

and handed over) **for the servants. And We brought to life** (*aḥyaynā*; √H-Y-Y; life, the quickening) **with it a dead tract** (*balḍab*; √B-L-D; a bounded piece of ground, a place one settles). **Thus is the coming out** (*al-khurūj*; √KH-R-J; going out from where one was enclosed; the joining word is *kadhālike*, thus, a particle of sameness and not of likeness, and the same noun names the Day at 50:42) (11)

The Roll of the Deniers · verse: 12-15 · head at verse 12

Verse twelve states the class, they called it false before them, and thirteen and fourteen enumerate its members. The head's kadhdhabat returns at the foot of fourteen as kadhdhaba, closing the block on its own root, and fifteen turns the objection of verse three back on itself.

Before them the people (*qawm*; √Q-W-M; those who stand, the same root as *qiyāma*, the Standing) **of Nūḥ AS called it false, and the companions** (*aṣḥāb*; √Ṣ-H-B; those who keep company on a road) **of the Well** (*al-Rass*; √R-S-S; a well sunk and then stopped up) **and Thamūd (12) and 'Ād and Fir'awn and the brothers** (*ikhwān*; √-KH-W; born of the same, joined at the origin) **of Lūṭ AS (13) and the companions of the Thicket** (*al-Ayḳab*; √-Y-K; trees grown so close they tangle) **and the people of Tubba'.** Each called the sent ones false (*al-rusul*; √R-S-L; *rasl*, the loose easy gait of a camel let go; the sending is a letting-forth) **and My warning fell due** (*ḥaqqā*; √H-Q-Q at its second sense, the falling-due of what was owed · *wa'id*; √W-'-D; the promise, and the promise of harm) **(14) Were We then worn out** (*'ayīnā*; √-Y-Y; coming to a stop for want of a way forward, the tongue that cannot find the word) **by the first making** (*al-khalq*; √KH-L-Q; measuring out leather and cutting it to a pattern · *al-awwal*; √-W-L; the first, and the returning-to) **? Rather, they are in a confusion** (*labs*; √L-B-S; the covering, and the making-indistinct, 2:187) **about a new making** (*jadīd*; √J-D-D; freshly cut, the root also carrying the severing) (15)

Nearer Than the Vein · verse: 16-18 · head at verse 16

Verse sixteen states the thesis whole, the making, the known whisper, and the nearness closer than the neck's own vessel, and seventeen and eighteen supply the mechanism: two seated receivers and a watcher ready at every utterance. Registration is continuous here and not a final audit.

And We have made the human (*al-insān*; √-N-S; drawing near in company, growing familiar; a second derivation from √N-S-Y, forgetting, is proposed classically and is not secure) **and We know what his self** (*nafs*; √N-F-S; the breath, and from the breath the self that breathes) **whispers to him** (*tuwaswisu*; √W-S-W-S; quadriliteral, the faint repeated sound, the low tinkling of ornaments just at the edge of hearing) , **and We are nearer** (*aqrab*; √Q-R-B; coming near; a closing of the standoff and not a line crossed) **to him than the cord** (*ḥabl*; √H-B-L; the twisted rope) **of the vein of the neck** (*al-warīd*; √W-R-D; *wurūd*, coming down to water; *mawrid*, the watering place; the vessel is named for arriving, and the nearness is stated nearer than the arriving itself) **(16) When the two receivers receive** (*al-mutalaqqiyān*; √L-Q-Y, glossed at 50:7 as the casting; here at stem V, the taking of what is cast) , **seated** (*qa'id*; √Q-'-D; sitting, settled and not passing by) **on the right** (*al-yamīn*; √Y-M-N; the right hand, and the good fortune read off it) **and on the left** (*al-shimāl*; √SH-M-L; the left hand, and the enfolding that takes in the whole) **(17) He casts out no word** (*yalfiẓu*; √L-F-Z; throwing a thing clear of the mouth · *qawl*; √Q-W-L; the said thing) **but that with him is a watcher** (*raqīb*; √R-Q-B; *raqabah*, the neck; the craning of the neck to keep a thing in view, cf. the record fastened at the neck, 17:13) **ready at hand** (*'atīd*; √-T-D; standing prepared, wanting nothing further) (18)

The Cover Removed · verse: 19-26 · reader's cut

The found grade is barred at intake on genre: this is a narrative sequence, ordered by event and not by topic, so heading-plus-body cannot apply. The cut is the reader's. What the passage carries is the load-bearing verse of the sūra, the cover lifted and the sight gone iron, with the possessive on the cover and nothing moved in space.

And the stopping-up of death came (*sakrah*; √S-K-R; *sakr*, the dam that stops running water, and the clouding of the mind that follows; both senses stand in the root) **with the settled truth. That is what you were swerving from** (*taḥīdu*; √Ḥ-Y-D; turning the body aside off a road one was on) **(19) And the horn was blown** (*nufikha*; √N-F-KH; breath driven out through a narrow opening, the same act as the breathing-in at 15:29 · *al-ṣūr*; √Ṣ-W-R; the horn; the root also gives *ṣūrah*, form, and whether the word here is the horn or the plural of form is disputed in the tradition). **That is the Day** (*yawm*; √Y-W-M; the day, the bounded stretch of time) **of the warning (20) And every self came, with it a driver** (*sā'iq*; √S-W-Q; driving a herd forward from behind; the root also gives *sāq*, the shank) **and a witness** (*shahīd*; √SH-H-D; being present at a thing, and testifying to what one was present at) **(21) You were in heedlessness** (*ghaflah*; √GH-F-L; *ghufl*, a thing with no mark on it, a beast unbranded, a tract with no landmark; the exact privation of the *'alam* at 50:4, where knowing was named from the landmark) **of this, so We removed** (*kashafnā*; √K-SH-F; drawing a covering off a thing) **from you your cover** (*ghīṭā'*; √GH-Ṭ-Y; the lid laid over, the veil laid across; the possessive is on the cover and not on the distance) , **so your sight** (*baṣar*; √B-Ṣ-R, glossed at 50:8) **today is iron** (*ḥadīd*; √Ḥ-D-D; the cutting edge, and iron named from it, cf. *ḥudūd*, the limits, 2:187) **(22) And his yoked one said** (*qarīn*; √Q-R-N; two beasts yoked at the horn to draw together; *qarn*, the horn, and *qirān*, the joining) , **this is what is with me, ready (23) Cast into Jahannam** (*jahannam*; the name is not native Arabic; the tradition and the philologists trace it through Aramaic to Hebrew *gē-hinnōm*, the valley of Hinnom outside Jerusalem, and the borrowing is early; the derivation is well supported and is not certain) **every hardened coverer-over** (*kaffār*; √K-F-R at its intensive pattern, the covering made habitual) **who stands aside** (*'anīd*; √'N-D; turning off and holding the turn, standing away from what one has left) **(24) A withholder** (*mannā'*; √M-N-'; keeping a thing back from the hand reaching for it) **of good** (*khayr*; √KH-Y-R; the good, and the choosing of it; the root carries both) , **one who runs past the bound** (*mu'tad*; √'D-W; running, and running beyond) , **unsettled by doubt** (*murīb*; √R-Y-B; the unease that will not let a thing be trusted, cf. *lā rayba fīhi*, 2:2) **(25) who set up** (*ja'ala*; √J-'; putting a thing into a place and making it hold there) **beside Allah** ﷻ **another god** (*ilāh*; √'L-H; the one turned to; the root's floor is debated · *ākhar*; √'KH-R; what stands behind, the after-side, the same root as *al-ākhirah*) , **so cast him into the tight-drawn punishment** (*al-'adhāb*; √'DH-B; the root also gives *'adhb*, sweet water, and the relation between the two senses is disputed and is not resolved here · *shadīd*; √SH-D-D; pulling a knot tight until nothing gives) **(26)**

The Companion Disowns · verse: 27-30 · reader's cut

Barred at intake on genre: an exchange is organized by turns and not by topic. The yoked one speaks, the answer comes, and the dispute itself is refused. The external agent is removed twice and the section closes at the cavity's unanswered question.

His yoked one said, our Lord (*rabb*; √R-B-B; rearing a thing and tending it until it reaches its full growth) , **I did not make him overflow** (*atḡhaytu*; √Ṭ-GH-Y; water rising past the lip that held it, cf. *lammā ṭaghā al-mā'*, 69:11) , **but he was in far straying** (*ḍalāl*; √Ḍ-L-L; losing the road, the track no longer found) **(27) He said, do not dispute** (*takhtaṣimū*; √KH-Ṣ-M; two edges set against each other, adversaries at a corner) **before Me, and I have already put forward** (*qaddamtū*; √Q-D-M; *qadam*, the foot; setting the foot ahead) **the warning to you (28) The word is not exchanged** (*yubaddalu*; √B-D-L; putting one thing in the place of another) **with Me, and I am no wronger** (*ẓallām*; √Z-L-M; setting a thing where it does not belong, and the dark; the root carries the misplacing and the darkness together) **of the servants (29) On the Day We say to Jahannam, are you filled** (*imtala'ī*; √M-L-'; a vessel taken to its brim) ? **And it says, is there any more** (*mazīd*; √Z-Y-D; addition, what is put on top of what is there; the phrase is read in the tradition as a demand for more and also as a denial that more will fit, and the corpus's own second use of the word five verses on, at 50:35, leans it toward the first) **(30)**

The Garden Brought Near · verse: 31-35 · head at verse 31

Verse thirty-one states it, the Garden brought forward to close range and not far, and thirty-two through thirty-five supply the recipient and the contents. The head's jannah governs the whole block and no new operation opens inside it. The block closes on the word the cavity asked with one verse earlier, now stated rather than asked and given an address.

And the Garden was brought forward to close range (*uzlifāt*; √Z-L-F; *zulfab*, nearness; drawing a thing up until it stands just there; the verb is passive, the bringing is not the Garden's own act) **for those who guard themselves** (*al-muttaqīn*; √W-Q-Y; raising a shield between oneself and a blow) , **not far (31) This is what you were promised, for every returner** (*awwāb*; √-W-B; *iyāb*, the coming home; the intensive pattern, one who returns and returns; a second returning-root beside the *munīb* of 50:8) **who keeps (32) who feared** (*khashiya*; √KH-SH-Y; the dread that comes from knowing the size of a thing, distinguished from the plain fright of √KH-W-F at 50:45) **the Merciful** (*al-Raḥmān*; √R-Ḥ-M; *raḥim*, the womb; the mercy is named from the organ that holds and feeds what cannot yet feed itself) **while He is unseen** (*al-ghayb*; √GH-Y-B; gone down out of sight, as the sun goes) , **and came with a turning heart** (*qalb*; √Q-L-B; the thing that turns over; the organ is named for its overturning and not for its beating · *munīb*, glossed at 50:8) **(33) Enter it** (*udkhubū*; √D-KH-L; going in through an opening) **in wholeness** (*salām*; √S-L-M; sound, entire, with nothing broken off; recd. peace) . **That is the Day of abiding** (*al-khulūd*; √KH-L-D; remaining and not passing away) **(34) They have there whatever they will** (*yashāʾūn*; √SH-Y-ʾ; willing, the root of *shayʾ*, thing, at 50:2) , **and with Us is more (35)**

Is There Any Swerving Away · verse: 36-38 · reader's cut

The head-and-body marks hold only partially here and partial does not meet the bar, so the cut is the reader's. Verse thirty-six carries its own question, thirty-seven states the condition on which the reminder lands, and thirty-eight negates the fatigue a second time, with the coming out three verses later.

And how many We destroyed (*ahlaknā*; √H-L-K; a thing coming to nothing, perishing) **before them of a generation** (*qarn*; √Q-R-N, glossed at 50:23; a generation is those yoked into one span) **stronger than them in grip** (*baṭṣ*; √B-Ṭ-SH; the hand seizing hard and not letting go) , **and they bored through** (*naqqabū*; √N-Q-B; piercing a hole clean through a wall or a hide) **the lands. Is there any swerving away** (*mahī*; √H-Y-Ṣ; turning aside to get clear; a second swerve-root beside the *taḥīd* of 50:19, and the two bracket the judgment between them) **(36) In that is a reminding for whoever has a heart, or gave the ear** (*al-samʿ*; √S-M-ʿ; hearing, the ear's own act) **while he is present (37) And We made the heavens and the ground and what is between them in six days, and no weariness** (*luḡhūb*; √L-GH-B; the slackness that comes over a body after hard effort) **touched Us** (*massanā*; √M-S-S; skin meeting a thing, the lightest contact) **(38)**

Hold Fast and Listen · verse: 39-45 · reader's cut

Partial only, so the cut is the reader's. The close turns to the one addressed: bind fast, swim in praise at the three hinges of the day, then listen for the caller from the near place. It ends on the one instruction about force.

So bind yourself fast (*isbir*; √S-B-R; holding a thing tied in its place so it cannot break away; recd. be patient) **against what they say, and swim in the praise** (*sabbih*; √S-B-Ḥ; swimming, moving freely and continuously through a medium that holds one up · *ḥamd*; √Ḥ-M-D; praise given for what a thing is and not only for what it gave) **of your Lord before the rising** (*tulūʿ*; √Ṭ-L-ʿ; glossed at 50:10, the same coming-up as the palm's spathe) **of the sun** (*al-shams*; √SH-M-S; the sun) **and before the going-down** (*al-ghurūb*; √GH-R-B; departing out of sight westward; the root also gives *gharīb*, the stranger, the one gone from his own place) **(39) And of the night** (*al-layl*; √L-Y-L; the night) **swim in His praise, and after the prostrations** (*adbār*; √D-B-R; *dubur*, the back and hind part; what comes behind a thing · *al-sujūd*; √S-J-D; lowering the forehead to the ground) **(40) And listen** (*istamiʿ*; √S-M-ʿ at stem X, seeking out the hearing rather than receiving it) **for the Day the caller calls** (*al-munādi*; √N-D-Y; the raised voice that gathers, the root of *nadwah*, the assembly) **from a near place** (*makān*; √K-W-N; the place of being, from the verb of being itself · *qarīb*; √Q-R-B, glossed at 50:16) **(41) The Day they hear the cry** (*al-ṣayḥah*; √S-Y-Ḥ; a single shout at full voice) **with the settled truth. That is the Day of the coming out (42) It is We who give life and give death, and to Us is the coming-to** (*al-maṣīr*; √S-Y-R; becoming, turning into; the destination is named as what a thing becomes and not as a place it travels) **(43) The Day the ground splits open** (*tashaqqaqu*; √SH-Q-Q; cleaving lengthwise, the two faces parting) **away from them, hurrying** (*sirāʿ*; √S-R-ʿ; haste, the same root as the command to hasten toward forgiveness, 3:133) . **That is a**

gathering (*ḥaṣhr*; √H-SH-R; driving scattered things together into a narrow place) **easy for Us** (*yasīr*; √Y-S-R; costing little, going smoothly; the root also carries plenty) **(44) We know best what they say, and you are not over them one who sets by force** (*jabbār*; √J-B-R; *jabara*, to set a broken bone straight, and to compel; the root carries the mending and the forcing together, and the sentence denies the second of the Messenger ﷺ) . **So remind by the Recitation whoever fears** (*yakhāfu*; √KH-W-F; plain fright at a thing coming, distinguished from the awed dread of √KH-SH-Y at 50:33) **My warning (45)**

CLOSING SYNTHESIS

What the sūra established, it established by refusing to argue. The objection was that a return across dust is a far thing, and the reply set a seamless vault, a moored ground, water that comes down, and a tract brought back from death, and then joined the two with a particle of sameness rather than of likeness. The emergence is not illustrated by the cycle. It is named as the cycle, and the objector is standing in it while he objects.

The through-line binding the sections is the near and far axis carried in the rhyme. *Far* is spoken three times and every time by someone who cannot see: the deniers at the third verse, the yoked one at the twenty-seventh, and then the word itself is negated when the Garden is brought forward. What lies between those uses is the account of why a covered eye reports distance. The heedlessness at verse twenty-two is *ghaṭṭab*, from the root of the unbranded beast and the tract without a landmark, and the knowing at verse four is from *‘alam*, the landmark itself. One root gives the mark, the other its absence, and the sūra sets them eighteen verses apart on the same axis. The cover is then lifted with a possessive on it, *your* cover, and the sight goes iron. Nothing crossed a distance. A lid came off.

The core claim is stated twice in one word. The cavity asks *hal min mazīd*, is there more, and receives no answer; five verses later the Garden's people are told they have what they will, and the more is stated rather than asked and given an address, *ladaynā*, with Us. The one who asks is inside the thing that cannot be filled. The one who receives is not asking, and what exceeds his wish is held at the source. Between those two verses stands the only verb the Garden needs: *uzlifat*, it was brought forward, passive, not travelled to.

And the sūra ends by taking force off the table. The last instruction to the Messenger ﷺ is that he is not set over them as a *jabbār*, from the root that sets a broken bone and also compels. He is given the reminding and refused the compelling. A gate that must be entered in wholeness cannot be forced from outside, and the sūra closes on exactly that.

Division of the blocks, reported. Nine blocks, four found and five authored. The found heads stand at verses 6, 12, 16 and 31, each meeting the marks: the head states an operation and the body supplies its particulars, no new operation opens inside the block, and a root at the head returns at or near its foot. Three blocks are barred at intake, verses 1-5 on the formula opening the corpus itself controls at Q 38:1-2, verses 19-26 on narrative sequence, and verses 27-30 on dialogue. Two hold the marks only partially, verses 36-38 and 39-45, and partial does not meet the bar. The ratio is printed because a unit reporting all-found has fitted its cuts to the pattern, and the cheapest check on that is the count. And the division carries evidence about composition history in neither direction: a found head is not evidence of unitary composition and an authored cut is not evidence of a seam, since a hypothesis confirmed by the pattern holding and equally confirmed by its breaking cannot be refuted by either.